

Connotation - Workbook 1

Focused practice - Workbook 1 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each short text closely. Answer without checking the key. Then compare your reasoning with the explanation and mark the mistake type if you were wrong.

Before you start

- Underline or mentally mark the exact wording that controls your answer.
- Do not choose an option just because it is true in general; it must fit this text.
- After checking, write one sentence explaining why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Community Garden

The article describes the volunteers as a determined group who returned every weekend until the abandoned lot was cleared.

1. What connotation does determined have here?

- A. positive persistence
- B. careless behavior
- C. secretive behavior
- D. confusion

2. Which replacement would make the sentence more negative?

- A. committed
- B. stubborn
- C. steady
- D. dedicated

Budget Memo

The memo says departments should trim nonessential spending before requesting additional funds.

3. What does trim suggest compared with cut?

- A. a controlled reduction rather than complete removal
- B. a larger increase
- C. a legal penalty
- D. a secret payment

4. Why might the writer choose trim?

- A. To make the reduction sound more moderate
- B. To prove the budget is balanced
- C. To describe hair
- D. To make the memo humorous

Old Warehouse

A preservation group called the warehouse a landmark, while a developer called it a relic that blocked new housing.

5. Which word has the more positive connotation?

- A. landmark
- B. relic
- C. blocked
- D. housing

6. What does the contrast reveal?

- A. The two sides describe the same building with different attitudes.
- B. The warehouse is in two locations.
- C. The developer wants to preserve it.
- D. Neither side has an opinion.

Answer key and reasoning

Community Garden

1. A. Determined presents the volunteers' persistence positively.
2. B. Stubborn often suggests unreasonable refusal to change, creating a more negative judgment.

Budget Memo

3. A. Trim has a milder, more measured connotation than cut away entirely.
4. A. The softer wording frames the action as limited and manageable.

Old Warehouse

5. A. Landmark suggests importance and value; relic can suggest something outdated.
6. A. The literal subject is the same, but the connotations reveal opposing attitudes.

Mistake review

- If you chose a familiar meaning that did not fit the context, label it wrong sense.
- If you chose an option based on one word but ignored the rest of the passage, label it one-clue trap.
- If you understood the basic meaning but missed attitude or effect, label it effect missed.
- Redo the question later without looking at the key.